

“I pledge you, I pledge myself, to a **new deal** for the **American people.**”

FRANKLIN D. ROOSEVELT, PRESIDENTIAL NOMINATION ACCEPTANCE SPEECH, CHICAGO, JULY 2, 1932

1929 First Academy Awards (“Oscars”) are presented in Hollywood.

1929 New York stock market collapses on Black Tuesday, October 29, leading to major national and then international economic depression.

1930 The US population hits 123 million, up 30 million since 1910.

1931 The Empire State Building opens in New York and remains the world’s tallest building for more than 40 years.

1932 Franklin D. Roosevelt wins the election as Democratic candidate over the incumbent Republican president Herbert Hoover.

1933 Roosevelt becomes president, stating at his inauguration that “the only thing we have to fear is fear itself.” Faced with near economic collapse and a run on the banking system, he calls an immediate session of Congress. In an unprecended 100 days of legislation, he tackles banking, industry, agriculture, labor, and agricultural relief in order to promote economic recovery. Among the many new institutions he sets up to reduce unemployment are the Federal Relief Emergency Administration, the Civilian Conservation Corps, the Tennessee Valley Authority, and the Civic Works Administration.

1933 Roosevelt makes the first of his nationwide radio “fireside chats” to the American people in March, using this and later broadcasts to explain his policies and reassure the people about their future.

1933 The 21st Amendment to the Constitution repeals the 18th Amendment of 1919 and ends Prohibition.

1934 Drought turns much of the midwest into a dust bowl, while farm prices have dropped by half over the previous four years. Many farmers are forced to sell their land and leave.

1935 The Supreme Court rules that the National Industrial Recovery Act, which regulates wages, hours, working conditions, and collective bargaining in factories, is unconstitutional.

1935 The Social Security Act provides old age pensions and unemployment benefits, and help for children with disabilities. The Act is one of the most important pieces of social legislation passed in the US and remains the basis for most federal welfare provisions today.

1936 The Supreme Court invalidates the New Deal Agricultural Adjustment Act.

Roosevelt’s subsequent attempt to reform the court’s membership fails, tarnishing his reputation.

1936 Roosevelt wins a landslide reelection victory, carrying every state except Maine and Vermont and winning the greatest electoral majority since 1820. The Democrats achieve large majorities in both houses of Congress. He takes office in 1937, stating that “I see one-third of a nation ill-housed, ill-clad, ill-nourished.”

1939 US remains neutral as World War II breaks out in Europe in September.

1940 US gains the right to acquire leases on British bases in the Americas, such as those in Newfoundland, Bermuda, and the Caribbean, in order to defend itself against possible attack. The first peacetime program of compulsory military service is introduced, providing for the registration of all men between ages 21 and 35. Other measures are taken to prepare the country for a possible war against Germany or Japan.

1940 President Roosevelt becomes the first American to be elected to a third term as president.

1941 Mount Rushmore Memorial, bearing the portraits of presidents Washington, Jefferson, Theodore Roosevelt, and Lincoln, is completed.

1941 Lend-Lease Act gives arms and other war supplies to Britain by sale, transfer, exchange, or lease. Soon-to-be supplied items are the mass-produced Liberty ships, each one taking at most 42 days to build.



Liberty ships

The Liberty merchant ships were prefabricated in sections for assembly in a shipyard: 600 were built in 1942 alone. Each took vital supplies to Britain.

US OVERSEAS TERRITORIES	
INCORPORATED TERRITORIES	UNINCORPORATED TERRITORIES
PUERTO RICO The Commonwealth of Puerto Rico is the easternmost of the Greater Antilles chain in the Caribbean. Its population density is higher than in any US state. 15th century Puerto Rico is discovered by Columbus and colonized by Spain. 1868 Revolt against colonial rule leads to unsuccessful declaration of independence. 1898 During the Spanish-American War US troops occupy Puerto Rico; the island is ceded by Spain to the US. 1917 Puerto Ricans gain US citizenship. 1932 Name changes from Porto Rico to Puerto Rico. 1947 Limited self-government granted. 1952 Puerto Rico is granted commonwealth association with the US. 1967 A plebiscite on relations with the US results in a 60 percent vote for continuing autonomous commonwealth status. 1968 The pro-statehood New Progressive Party (NPP) under Luis A. Ferre wins the governorship election. 1991 A referendum on the island’s future relationship with the US results in a majority in favor of closer integration. 1992 NPP wins governorship and legislative elections. 1993, 1998 Nonbinding referenda produce narrow results in favor of retaining commonwealth status. 2001 Pro-statehood NPP governor replaced by anti-statehood Sila Calderón—the first female governor of Puerto Rico.	AMERICAN SAMOA Island group in the southern Pacific. 1899 US and Germany agree to divide Samoan islands between them. 1960 Samoan legislature gains limited law-making authority.
	GUAM Volcanic island at the southern end of the Northern Marianas. 1521 Magellan discovers Guam and claims it for Spain. 1899 Spain cedes island to US. 1950 US Interior Department runs the island; Guamanians gain full US citizenship.
	US VIRGIN ISLANDS Group of islands east of Puerto Rico. 1493 Discovered by Columbus and claimed for Spain. 1672 Danes first settle in islands. 1754 Danish colony established. 1917 Purchased by US for \$25 million because of their strategic position on sea routes to the Panama Canal. 1932 Islanders given US citizenship. 1954 US Interior Department runs islands.
	OTHER ISLANDS Howland, Baker & Jarvis Islands, Palmyra Atoll Four small Pacific islands, southwest of Hawaii, administered by the US Department of the Interior (DOI). Johnson Atoll Two small Pacific islands 680 miles (1,100 km) southwest of Hawaii, administered by the DOI. Kingman Reef Small Pacific reef, 930 miles (1,500 km) southwest of Hawaii, administered by the US Navy. Midway Islands Two small islands at the the western end of the Hawaiian chain, administered by the DOI. Navassa Island Small Caribbean island, 30 miles (48 km) west of Haiti, administered by the DOI. Wake Island Three small Pacific islands 2,300 miles (3,700 km) west of Hawaii, administered by the DOI.

1941 US troops land in Iceland to prevent its occupation by Germany for use as a naval or air base against the US.

1941–46 The Manhattan Project, code name for the program to build an atomic bomb, begins after Albert Einstein (at the urging of several other scientists) warns President Roosevelt that Nazi Germany may be developing such a weapon. The program, led by army general Leslie Groves and civilian scientist J. Robert Oppenheimer, involves a massive yet secret effort that ultimately costs \$2 billion. The first bomb is successfully tested at Alamogordo, New Mexico, on July 16, 1945.

1941 Pearl Harbor: On the morning of December 7, Japanese planes launch a surprise attack on the US naval base at Pearl Harbor in Hawaii, later attacking the

American Philippines, Guam, and Midway. President Roosevelt calls it “a date which will live in infamy.” The US declares war on Japan; Germany and Italy—Japan’s allies—declare war on the US.

1942 In the Pacific, US forces are pushed on the defensive until they stop the Japanese advance at the Battle of the Coral Sea in May, then turn the tide at Midway in June. Both battles are fought at sea using aircraft carriers operating over vast distances. In November, US and Allied troops land in North Africa to fight against German and Italian troops.

1943 As US troops fight their way across the Pacific, US and Allied troops invade Italy in July. Conferences between the Allied leaders in Québec, Tehran, and Cairo map out the war strategy.